insurgent groups. During my official visit as the army chief to Myanmar at the end of October 2005, we requested them to take action to deny such havens to Indian terrorist organizations. Though they promised to do so, in actual fact, it is believed that the Myanmar army is not in a position to take effective steps against insurgents in some of the remote border areas. Our government agreed to give a comprehensive military assistance package to Myanmar and I was happy to convey this to them. Besides that, I also promised to establish an IT facility for training their cadets on computers and other aspects related to IT. It was set up by our team of officers and men from the Corps of Signals within a year. General and Mrs Maung Aye hosted a dinner in honour of our delegation. We will never forget the beautiful golf courses that we saw and the pleasure of a round with General Maung Aye on one of them too.

We have a dynamic army-to-army cooperation with the Singapore army. We have been regularly doing joint training with them at sub unit level at Babina, near Jhansi, and Nasik. During my official visit to Singapore, we were given a warm welcome, and I had very meaningful interactions with their army chief, General Desmond Kuek, who is now their chief of defence staff. The island state has made phenomenal progress in all fields, including defence-related industry.

The reciprocal goodwill visit to Japan in April 2007 helped me to enhance the level of military cooperation and the rapport established with their military leadership, particularly with General Tsutomu Mori. He had visited India during my tenure as chief, and hosted a dinner for us when we were transiting through Tokyo in November 2006. By 2007, General Ryoichi Oriki had taken over and I had useful interaction with him and also called on the minister of defence, Kyuma Furnis. My programme included visits to 1st Airborne Brigade and the Middle Army HQ at Osaka. I was very impressed with the Japanese efficiency and warmth I witnessed during the visit.